Eli's Reading Practice

Level 2 (about 4.0 grade level) • Words from Vowel Sounds /är/, /âr/ & /îr/
Read each passage carefully, then answer the questions. Use the passage to find evidence for your answers.

A Ride to the Town Square

(fiction)

Jamal wanted to ride to the town square with his sister, Lila. Before they left, they had to prepare their bikes. Jamal's chain was loose, so Dad helped him repair it. Lila packed a spare water bottle and a small snack. "If we get weary, we can rest on a bench," she said. They put on helmets and started their short journey down the hill. At the bottom, Jamal had to shift into a lower gear. A dog behind a fence began to bark, but it did not scare them. In the square, a crowd had come to cheer for a school band. Lila thought the tuba made a weird, deep sound, and she smiled. They sat in the rear of the crowd so they could still see the drums. After the song, they compared the two best songs and could not pick a favorite. On the way home, Jamal said the trip was even better than he could imagine.

Questions

1. What is this story mostly about?

a) Jamal and Lila get their bikes ready and ride to a concert in the town square.
b) Dad buys two new bikes for the family.
c) A dog scares the children off the road.
d) Lila writes a song for the school band.

2. What did Lila pack for the ride?

a) a map and a camera
b) a spare water bottle and a small snack
c) two extra helmets
d) a tuba

3. Why did Jamal shift into a lower gear at the bottom of the hill?

a) His chain had fallen off again.
b) He wanted to stop and go home.
c) A lower gear would help him ride more easily after the downhill run.
d) The dog was chasing the bike.

4. "If we get weary, we can rest on a bench." What does weary mean?

a) lost
b) very tired
c) hungry

d) late

5. Which sentence shows why the crowd was in the square?

a) Jamal wanted to ride to the town square with his sister, Lila.
b) They put on helmets and started their short journey down the hill.
c) In the square, a crowd had come to cheer for a school band.
d) On the way home, Jamal said the trip was even better than he could imagine.

6. What happened right after the song ended?

a) They put on their helmets.
b) They sat in the rear of the crowd.
c) They compared the two best songs.
d) Dad repaired the chain.

7. Why did Dad help Jamal before the ride?

a) Jamal's chain was loose and needed repair.
b) Lila had forgotten her helmet.
c) The town square was closed.
d) The dog was already barking.

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

repair: _____

spare: _____

weary: _____

journey: _____

gear: _____

When an Animal Grows Scarce

(nonfiction)

Sometimes a kind of animal becomes scarce in a place where it once was common. Scientists try to measure how many of those animals are left. They also try to notice what has changed in the animals' home. A harsh winter, a dry summer, or new buildings can all be part of the problem. People may need to improve the habitat instead of waiting for the animals to come back on their own. One solution is to protect the land where the animals raise their young. Another is to keep dogs on leashes so they do not scare nesting birds. Scientists compare counts from year to year to see if the plan is working. They stay aware of new risks, such as a disease or a flood. It is unusual for a species to recover in just one season. The opposite can also happen: a species can grow too quickly and crowd out others. Careful work over several years gives the animals the best chance. When people act early, a scarce animal has a much better chance to thrive.

Questions

1. What is this article mostly about?

a) How to train a dog to stay on a leash.
b) Why some animals become scarce and what people can do to help.
c) How floods start in the spring.
d) How to count trees in a forest.

2. What is one solution named in the article?

a) Moving every animal to a zoo.
b) Waiting one season and doing nothing.
c) Protecting the land where the animals raise their young.
d) Building more roads through the habitat.

3. Why do scientists compare counts from year to year?

a) To see whether their plan is helping the animals.
b) To decide which animal is the most popular.
c) To find a new place to put buildings.
d) To measure the height of the trees.

4. "Sometimes a kind of animal becomes scarce." What does scarce mean?

a) easy to find everywhere
b) hard to find because there are not many left
c) too loud to count
d) brand new to the area

5. Which sentence shows that recovery usually takes time?

a) Scientists try to measure how many of those animals are left.
b) It is unusual for a species to recover in just one season.
c) Another is to keep dogs on leashes so they do not scare nesting birds.
d) They stay aware of new risks, such as a disease or a flood.

6. According to the article, what should people do instead of just waiting?

a) Move away from the habitat.
b) Improve the habitat.
c) Count the animals only once.
d) Let dogs run without leashes.

7. What can a harsh winter do, according to the article?

a) It always helps a species recover.
b) It can be part of the reason an animal becomes scarce.
c) It makes counting animals easier.
d) It has no effect on wildlife.

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

scarce: _____

measure: _____

solution: _____

unusual: _____

opposite: _____

Answer Key (for grown-ups)

A Ride to the Town Square

1. a) Jamal and Lila get their bikes ready and ride to a concert in the town square. [Main idea]
2. b) a spare water bottle and a small snack [Details]
3. c) A lower gear would help him ride more easily after the downhill run. [Inference]
4. b) very tired [Vocabulary in context]
5. c) In the square, a crowd had come to cheer for a school band. [Evidence]
6. c) They compared the two best songs. [Sequence]
7. a) Jamal's chain was loose and needed repair. [Cause & effect]

Vocab: repair = to fix something that is broken; spare = extra, kept in case it is needed; weary = very tired; journey = a trip from one place to another; gear = a part of a bike that helps you go faster or climb more easily

When an Animal Grows Scarce

1. b) Why some animals become scarce and what people can do to help. [Main idea]
2. c) Protecting the land where the animals raise their young. [Details]
3. a) To see whether their plan is helping the animals. [Inference]
4. b) hard to find because there are not many left [Vocabulary in context]
5. b) It is unusual for a species to recover in just one season. [Evidence]
6. b) Improve the habitat. [Sequence]
7. b) It can be part of the reason an animal becomes scarce. [Cause & effect]

Vocab: scarce = hard to find because there are not many left; measure = to find out the size, amount, or number of something; solution = a way to solve a problem; unusual = not common or not expected; opposite = completely different, or the other way around